aiPHeed Food Insecurity Forecast Report

Province Risk Level Trend

Area	Quezon
Period	2023 Q1 to 2026 Q4
Date prepared	18 October 2026
Prepared for	DA Region IV-A
Data	2026 Q4 forecast, lead 1, issued 2026-10-01

The risk score ranges from 0 to 1. It is the estimated chance that the province's hunger-and-food-price score -- regional hunger from the SWS survey plus twice the gap between the province's food inflation and the five-province average -- is above its usual level, the median of the past published quarters. A higher score means this combined pressure is more likely to be above its usual level. It is not a measure of how many families lack food. This report uses three risk levels: Alert (0.60 and above), High (0.50 to below 0.60) and Not elevated (below 0.50).

Key Points

- In 2026 Q4, the risk score for Quezon is 0.91, which is at the Alert level.
- Food prices are the main factor behind the score, accounting for about 85% of the factors, and they raise the risk.
- Compared with 2023 Q1, the risk score increased by 0.51 (from 0.40 to 0.91).
- The 2026 Q4 value is a forecast issued 2026-10-01; its outcome is not yet known.

Risk at a Glance

Table 1 shows the risk score, risk level and main factor for Quezon in 2026 Q4.

Table 1

Risk Score and Risk Level for Quezon, 2026 Q4

Province	Risk score	Risk level	Change from 2026 Q3	Main factor
Quezon	0.91	Alert	No change	Food prices (85%)

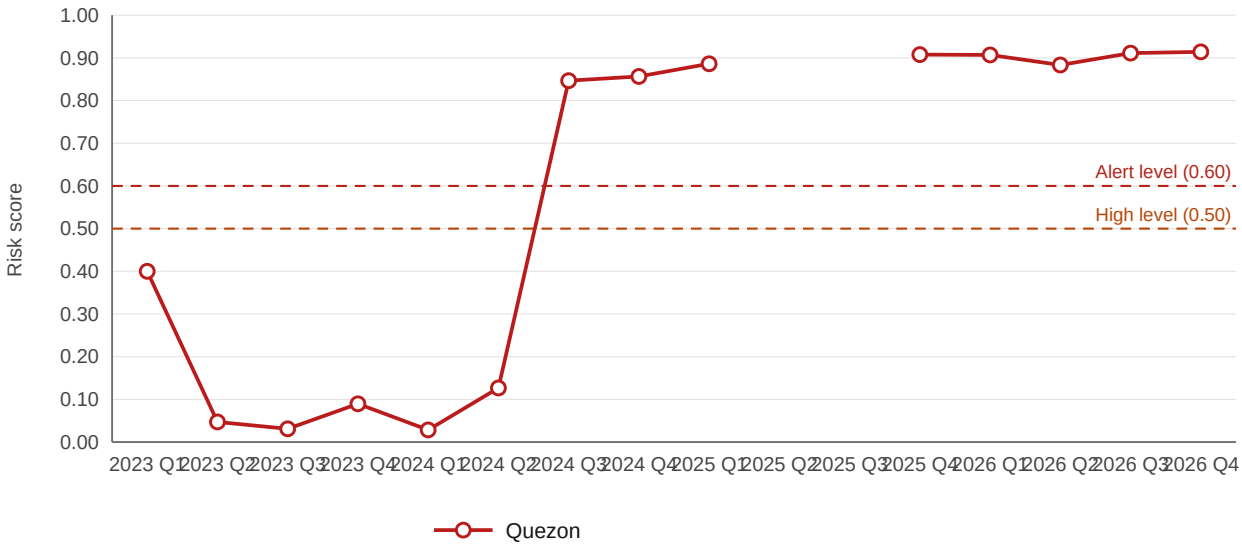
Note. Risk levels: Alert is 0.60 and above, High is 0.50 to below 0.60, and Not elevated is below 0.50. The main factor is the largest of the five factors behind each score. 2026 Q4: forecast, lead 1, issued 2026-10-01.

How Risk Changed

As shown in Figure 1, between 2023 Q1 and 2026 Q4 the risk score for Quezon increased by 0.51 (from 0.40 to 0.91).

Figure 1

Risk Scores for Quezon, 2023 Q1 to 2026 Q4



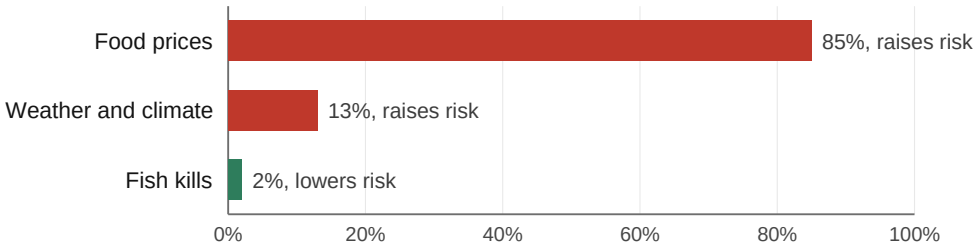
Note. Dashed lines mark the Alert level (0.60) and the High level (0.50). 2023 Q1 to 2026 Q3 are backtests on past quarters. 2026 Q4 is a forecast, lead 1, issued 2026-10-01. A gap in a line marks a quarter without a result. No estimate for 2025 Q2 and 2025 Q3: their SWS hunger rounds are recorded as supplementary, not as the approved (definition A) series, so these quarters have no approved label to estimate or score. This is missing data, not a low score.

What Is Driving the Risk

As shown in Figure 2, food prices account for about 85% of the factors behind Quezon's risk score in 2026 Q4 and raise the risk. Weather and climate account for about 13% and also raise the risk. Fish kills account for about 2% and lower the risk. Compared with 2026 Q3, the share of food prices fell from 90% to 85%. Of everything behind Quezon's score, about 43% comes from the regional hunger survey and the last published result, about 7% from the tone of the news and news reports that match none of the five factors, and about 50% from the five factors shown in the figure.

Figure 2

Factors Behind the Risk Score in Quezon, 2026 Q4



Note. Each bar shows a factor's share of the five factors behind the risk score; factors with no noticeable effect are not shown. Red bars raise the risk and green bars lower it. These are the model's associations, not causes.

Province Profile

Table 2 gives basic facts about Quezon.

Table 2

Population and Poverty Incidence of Quezon

Province	Population	Poverty incidence
Quezon	2,260,669	19.7%

Note. Population is the total of the province's cities and municipalities in the PSA 2024 Census of Population (POPCEN). Poverty incidence is the share of people below the poverty line: Population-weighted mean of the PSA 2021 city and municipal Small Area Estimates of poverty incidence (2024 POPCEN weights), over the cities and municipalities with an estimate; Lucena City has none (highly urbanized city, not in the PSA no-HUC table). Derived by aiPHeed; not an official PSA province figure.

News Reports

One validated news report about food conditions in Quezon was published in 2026 Q4.

It was about food prices.

The tone of the news and news reports that match none of the five factors account for about 7% of everything behind the score; news matched to a factor is counted within that factor.

The news for 2026 Q4 is not complete: the quarter is still running and reports are still being collected. The 2026 Q4 forecast was built from the news of 2026 Q3: no validated news reports.

Important Notes

- The risk score is the estimated chance that the combined hunger-and-food-price score is above its usual level. It is not a measure of hunger or of how many families lack food.
- By the study's rule (at least 75% correct on past quarters), results one quarter ahead are the reliable horizon: 85% were correct on development data. Results two quarters ahead were correct 71% of the time, so they are not shown.
- Results for 2023 Q1 to 2026 Q3 are backtests: each was estimated with only the data available before that quarter, but these quarters were also used while the model was being developed.
- No estimate for 2025 Q2 and 2025 Q3: their SWS hunger rounds are recorded as supplementary, not as the approved (definition A) series, so these quarters have no approved label to estimate or score. This is missing data, not a low score.
- City and municipal figures follow their province's score. They are not separate estimates for each city or municipality.
- This is not an official food insecurity classification. The report presents findings only; it does not recommend actions and should be used alongside DA Region IV-A's own guidance.